

3-2 Final Project Part I: Self-Assessment Investigation

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Abstract

This milestone consists of an analysis of the results from my self-assessment and then focus on the leadership of Mark Zuckerberg. It also contains an explanation of what impact his leadership skills had on Facebook and how the Zuckerberg's management style helped him accomplish goals. The following areas will be specifically addressed:

- An analysis results of professional self-assessment tools for informing personal appreciating of leadership skills and areas of professional development.
- Differentiation between leadership skills and management roles and functions for improving organizational structure, operations, and communication

3-2 Final Project Part I: Self-Assessment Investigation

According to the author of our textbook, leadership is the ability to inspire confidence and support among the people who are needed to achieve organizational goals (DuBrin, 2015).

Leadership is different from management because leaders don't always have authority or serve an executive function like a manager. Instead, leaders inspire and help the team accomplish goals. The textbook outlines several types of leaders in organizations:

- The Figurehead
- The Spokesperson
- The Negotiator
- The Coach
- The Team Player
- The Technical Guy

Each type of leader must use social skills to acquire followers and build networks. Along with an entrepreneurial spirit and talent, a leader strives to ensure that organizational goals are met (DuBrin, 2015).

Self-Assessment: Results

When I began the StrengthsFinder® assessment, I was not sure what to expect of the outcome. Generally, I am not a fan of personality tests nor do I give any credence to the results of such activities. Yet after completing the reading in our textbook and being presented with evidence-based proof that some traits are indeed shared by the most influential leaders I have come to accept that these tests serve a valuable purpose. According to the results of the assessment, I possess the following top three traits:

- Learner

- Achiever
- Restorative

As a learner, I must refine how I receive and process new information, designate myself as an early adopter of technology, honor my desire to learn, and be a catalyst for change. The achievement trait ensures that I strive to overcome challenges and enlist the help of focused individuals to tackle difficult tasks. Restoratives seek out roles where they are paid to solve problems (Gallup, 2016).

I can definitely identify with the learner and achiever traits. After all, I am continuing my education and strive to achieve my goals. Being a lifetime learner is extremely important to me and I think that education is the key to achieve my short and long term goals. I am not surprised that I was also designated as a restorative person because I often have to clean up other people's messes and fixing problems others have created. I think this is not a role that I favor or even seek out, but in the business world this is a task that I have grown to enjoy this task because it earns me recognition and provides a path towards advancement.

Compare and Contrast

In her 2014 article for Inc.com. Ekaterina Walter describes some the leadership traits that Zuckerberg has displayed during his meteoric rise. Walter notes that the Facebook CEO is extremely passionate about his work and seems to completely immerse himself in work (Walter, 2014). His work ethic and ability to focus intensely on a project sets the tone for his organization and inspires others to strive for perfection. This evidence supports the idea that Zuckerberg is a socialized charismatic leader. A true charismatic and transformational leader is highly concerned about human welfare and attaining organizational goals.

For the purposes of this exercise, I will assume that if Mark Zuckerberg were to complete the StrengthsFinder® assessment his top three leadership traits would be:

- Focus
- Analytical
- Achiever

While others start to wander down divergent avenues, people with strong focus talents stay on the main road. They help others avoid time-consuming distractions and keep everyone on point. People who are especially talented in the analytical theme search for reasons and causes. They have the ability to think about all the factors that might affect a situation. People who are especially talented in the achiever theme have a great deal of stamina and work hard. They take great satisfaction from being busy and productive (Gallup, 2016).

Both Zuckerberg and I share the achievement leadership trait. We both enjoy working hard and striving to reach a goal. Achievers especially need to make sure that things are in order and always double check to ensure that everything is going smoothly and according to plan. We also spend a lot of time preparing appropriate stories, vivid examples, graphic illustrations, or useful materials to share with teammates.

We differ when it comes to analyzing and focus on specific tasks. Although my self-assessment results did indicate that I possessed that analytical trait, it would be far more dominate in Zuckerberg's leadership style because of his ability to consider so many different factors that affect his organization. He also has the ability to focus his team more than I can, and that leadership trait has given him the ability to grow Facebook into a massive organization that dominates the internet.

Career Track

In his critically acclaimed book about the founding of Facebook, *The Accidental Billionaires*, Ben Mezrich describes Zuckerberg's role in the twist and turns of Facebook's storied history. Mezrich describes Zuckerberg as a socially awkward introvert who yearned to achieve greatness. He aligned himself with others who shared similar ambition including the controversial and eccentric founder of Napster, Sean Parker (Mezrich, 2009).

On the road to success, Mark and his cohorts developed a reputation as nonconformists and for using unconventional methods previously unthinkable in Silicon Valley. Zuckerberg and his team operated on the idea of subversion and exploited the desire for exclusivity (Mezrich, 2009). Aside from all of them being extremely gifted programmers and talented businessmen, the core team at Facebook lead by Zuckerberg where known for taking risks and making enemies.

Zuckerberg's legal troubles were well documented and widely known. He was accused of intellectual property theft and was sued by Facebook cofounder Eduardo Saverin (Mezrich, 2009). Zuckerberg settled these lawsuits for undisclosed amounts estimated to be in the hundreds of millions of dollars. These legal setbacks did little to deter Zuckerberg, though, which further reinforced his reputation for taking risks and doing everything to achieve his goals.

Leadership

A study conducted at Ohio State University identified that the two dimensions of leadership behavior are consideration for others and initiating structure (DuBrin, 2015). Zuckerberg's philanthropy gives insight into his consideration for humanity but it was his ability to initiate structure is what allowed him to grow Facebook into the dominant social-media platform it has become. Initiating structure is the degree to which the leader organizes and defines relationships in the group by such activities as assigning tasks and specifying procedures

(DuBrin, 2015). He also exhibits the entrepreneurial style of leadership which stems from his personal characteristics and the fact that he basically started the company himself.

Management

Our textbook defines charisma as a special quality of leaders whose purposes, powers, and extraordinary determination differentiate them from others (DuBrin, 2015). The three charismatic leader types are:

- Socialized
- Personalized
- Celebrity

According to Ashley Stahl's 2009 article in Forbes regarding his leadership, Mark Zuckerberg and his wife plan on donating the vast majority of their wealth to charitable causes and social advocacy groups (Stahl, 2009). Stahl mentions:

"His actions say it all: That helping others is of paramount importance. That we are all responsible for making this world a better place."

I think that we can all learn something from the world's youngest billionaire. Especially now in these tumultuous and uncertain times, Zuckerberg sets the right example for our generation by devoting himself to the causes that he thinks benefit humanity. Aside from his generosity and genuine consideration for the welfare of humanity, he is also an amazing innovator and entrepreneur that identified a market he could push forward and revolutionize with technology.

Reference

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